

IT Hardware and Communications Equipment

Read-through: AT&T Capex and iPhones

This morning AT&T reported Jun-Q (2Q26) earnings.

AT&T earnings have implications for stocks within our coverage universe, specifically service provider capex-exposed stocks (CIEN, CSCO, and GLW), as well as AAPL. For AT&T exposure, we estimate ~11% revenue for CIEN and LSD for overall GLW revenues (though we estimate roughly HSD of GLW's Optical revenues), and ~6% of iPhone units.

iPhones Unit Contribution from AT&T was roughly in-line with Street; 2Q26 capex came in above Street consensus: AT&T handset data points imply a unit contribution roughly meeting the Street expectations for AAPL iPhones with a tick down in the upgrade rate. 2Q26 capex came in at \$5.7Bn vs. the Street expectation of \$5.5Bn.

AT&T's handset and capex numbers:

- AT&T (T; covered by Kannan Venkateshwar) reported smartphone unit sales of 5.2M in Jun-Q, flat Y/Y.
- Upgrade rate moved down again to 3.2% in the Q (from 3.5% previous Q), down 10bps from a year ago and down 30bps sequentially, which we believe was largely due to faded enthusiasm around the carrier subsidies and the step-down in upgrade rate. We believe the telco reported upgrade rates are more important for this iPhone cycle as ASPs will likely increase by a decent amount.

Read-through for AAPL: We estimate AT&T sold roughly 3.4M iPhones in the quarter, flat Y/Y and down LSD sequentially. We think this implies in-line iPhones unit contribution for the quarter for AT&T, which we think is partially attributable to iPhone 17 line momentum, offset by a typically weaker Q2.

Capex read-through: 2Q26 capex came in above the Street at \$5.7B, though the company maintained the capital investment outlook to be in the range of \$23-24Bn annually for 2026, with the 2H capital investment being more back-end loaded. We view the reaffirmed full-year capex guide mostly neutral to our SP capex-exposed stocks in our coverage – CIEN, GLW, CSCO. Our sector continues to see a normalization in North America carrier activity. Similar to industry commentary, we expect telcos' ongoing fiber expansion to be lumpy for GLW, though we expect the recovery for SPs continuing in the back half. We continue to believe optical spend for capacity enhancements will be prioritized and expect CIEN's business with major US telcos to accelerate into next year.

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AT&T Handset-Related Metrics**FIGURE 1. Handset Metrics**

AT&T metrics	1Q22	2Q22	3Q22	4Q22	1Q23	2Q23	3Q23	4Q23	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26
Total smartphones	5.4	5.1	5.8	6.3	5.1	4.6	5.5	6.3	4.4	4.4	5.1	6.3	5.1	5.2	6.0	6.7	5.4	5.2
YoY change	5.9%	2.0%	3.6%	-4.5%	-5.6%	-9.8%	-5.2%	0.0%	-13.7%	-4.3%	-7.3%	0.0%	15.9%	18.2%	17.6%	6.3%	5.9%	0.0%
QoQ change	-18.2%	-5.6%	13.7%	8.6%	-19.0%	-9.8%	19.6%	14.5%	-30.2%	0.0%	15.9%	23.5%	-19.0%	2.0%	15.4%	11.7%	-19.4%	-3.7%
Postpaid subscribers	81.6	82.7	83.6	84.7	85.4	85.8	86.4	87.1	89.0	89.4	89.7	90.0	90.2	90.5	90.8	90.8	91.1	91.4
Smartphone % of subscribers	83.1%	83.0%	83.0%	82.9%	83.1%	83.7%	84.1%	84.3%	83.4%	83.9%	84.6%	85.2%	85.8%	86.4%	87.1%	87.9%	88.5%	89.0%
Smartphone subscribers	67.8	68.6	69.4	70.2	71.0	71.8	72.6	73.4	74.2	75.0	75.8	76.6	77.4	78.2	79.0	79.8	80.6	81.4
Upgrade rate	4.0%	3.6%	4.3%	4.8%	3.7%	3.1%	3.9%	4.7%	3.0%	2.9%	3.5%	4.6%	3.3%	3.3%	4.1%	4.7%	3.5%	3.2%
Upgrade units	3.3	2.9	3.6	4.0	3.1	2.6	3.3	4.1	2.6	2.6	3.1	4.1	3.0	3.0	3.7	4.3	3.2	2.9
iPhone units (estimates)	3.7	3.5	3.9	4.2	3.5	2.9	3.4	4.2	2.9	2.9	3.4	4.2	3.4	3.4	4.0	4.4	3.6	3.4
YoY change	20.0%	6.7%	5.1%	-7.3%	-5.3%	-15.1%	-13.5%	-1.5%	-16.5%	-1.4%	-1.3%	0.8%	15.9%	18.2%	17.6%	5.5%	5.9%	0.0%
QoQ change	-19.4%	-5.6%	13.7%	7.0%	-17.6%	-15.4%	15.8%	21.9%	-30.2%	0.0%	15.9%	24.5%	-19.7%	2.0%	15.4%	11.7%	-19.4%	-3.7%

Source: AT&T, Barclays Research. Mn units.

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AT&T (T, 21-Jul-2026, USD 22.26), Equal Weight/Neutral, A/CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

Apple, Inc. (AAPL, 21-Jul-2026, USD 327.74), Underweight/Neutral, CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

Ciena Corporation (CIEN, 21-Jul-2026, USD 408.73), Overweight/Neutral, CD/CE/J

Cisco Systems, Inc. (CSCO, 21-Jul-2026, USD 112.18), Equal Weight/Neutral, CD/CE/D/J/K/L/M

Corning Incorporated (GLW, 21-Jul-2026, USD 162.41), Equal Weight/Neutral, CD/CE/J

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Overweight - The stock is expected to outperform the unweighted expected total return of the industry coverage universe over a 12-month investment horizon.

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IT Hardware and Communications Equipment

Apple, Inc. (AAPL)	Arista Networks, Inc. (ANET)	Axon Enterprise, Inc. (AXON)
Celestica Inc. (CLS)	Ciena Corporation (CIEN)	Cisco Systems, Inc. (CSCO)
Corning Incorporated (GLW)	Corsair Gaming, Inc. (CRSR)	Dell Technologies Inc. (DELL)

Everpure, Inc. (P)	F5, Inc. (FFIV)	Fabrinet (FN)
Flex Ltd (FLEX)	Garmin (GRMN)	Harmonic, Inc. (HLIT)
Hewlett Packard Enterprise Company (HPE)	HP Inc. (HPQ)	Jabil (JBL)
Keysight Technologies, Inc. (KEYS)	Logitech (LOGI)	Motorola Solutions, Inc. (MSI)
NetApp, Inc. (NTAP)	Nutanix, Inc (NTNX)	Super Micro (SMCI)
Ubiquiti, Inc. (UI)		

North America Cable, Satellite & Telecom Services

AT&T (T)	BCE Inc. (BCE)	BCE Inc. (BCE.TO)
Charter Communications, Inc. (CHTR)	Comcast Corp. (CMCSA)	Optimum Communications Inc. (OPTU)
Rogers Communications Inc. (RCI)	Rogers Communications Inc. (RCI-B.TO)	T-Mobile US Inc. (TMUS)
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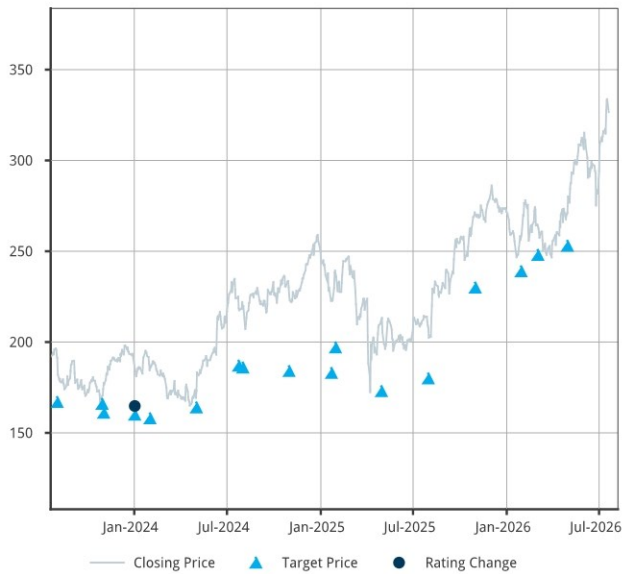
Apple, Inc. (AAPL / AAPL)

Stock Rating: **UNDERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 327.74** (21-Jul-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart (as of 21-Jul-2026)



Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target	Currency
30-Apr-2026	271.35		253.00	USD
03-Mar-2026	264.18		248.00	USD
29-Jan-2026	258.28		239.00	USD
31-Oct-2025	271.40		230.00	USD
31-Jul-2025	207.57		180.00	USD
30-Apr-2025	210.14		173.00	USD
30-Jan-2025	237.59		197.00	USD
22-Jan-2025	229.98		183.00	USD
31-Oct-2024	225.91		184.00	USD
01-Aug-2024	218.36		186.00	USD
24-Jul-2024	225.01		187.00	USD
02-May-2024	169.30		164.00	USD
01-Feb-2024	186.86		158.00	USD
02-Jan-2024	193.15	Underweight	160.00	USD
02-Nov-2023	177.57		161.00	USD
30-Oct-2023	168.22		166.00	USD
03-Aug-2023	191.17		167.00	USD

On 22-Jul-2023, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Equal Weight, and the adjusted price target was 149.00 USD.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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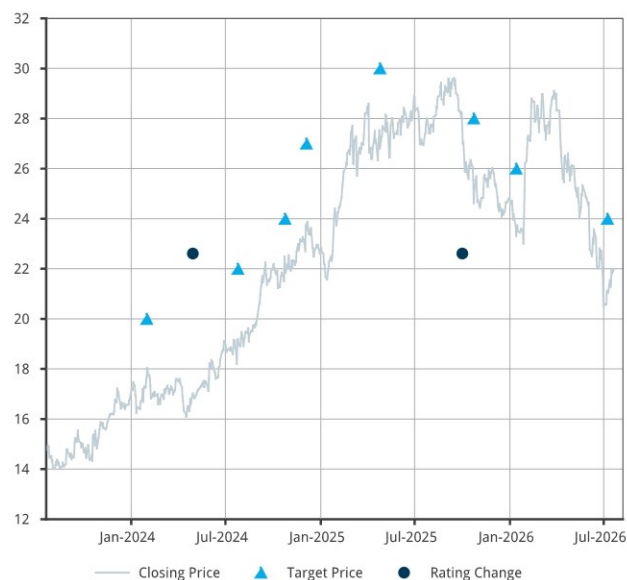
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Valuation Methodology: We rate AAPL Underweight with a price target of \$253. iPhone 17 cycle has been strong, though we remain cautious on sustainability, as well as cautious on other hardware categories and do not expect impressive Services growth going forward. Our PT is based on a 25x multiple of CY27e EPS of \$10.14. Our 25x P/E multiple remains below AAPL's 5-year historical multiple.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: Upside risks: 1) Stronger iPhone growth. Apple market shares peaked several years ago, and the company has not had a hit phone in a few years. Better iPhone sales could propel earnings and multiples. 2) Better Installed base impact on Services and better Services pull-through from hardware. 3) More benign regulation across App Store and TAC.

AT&T (T / T)Stock Rating: **EQUAL WEIGHT**Industry View: **NEUTRAL**Closing Price: **USD 22.26** (21-Jul-2026)**Rating and Price Target Chart (as of 21-Jul-2026)**

Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target	Currency
08-Jul-2026	20.58		24.00	USD
13-Jan-2026	23.74		26.00	USD
23-Oct-2025	25.55		28.00	USD
01-Oct-2025	28.07	Equal Weight		USD
25-Apr-2025	27.53		30.00	USD
04-Dec-2024	23.74		27.00	USD
24-Oct-2024	22.49		24.00	USD
25-Jul-2024	19.16		22.00	USD
29-Apr-2024	16.75	Overweight		USD
31-Jan-2024	17.53		20.00	USD

On 22-Jul-2023, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Equal Weight, and the adjusted price target was 17.00 USD.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our price target of \$24 is based on ~6.3x 2027E EBITDA.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: Increased wireless competition or pricing pressure, and execution risk.

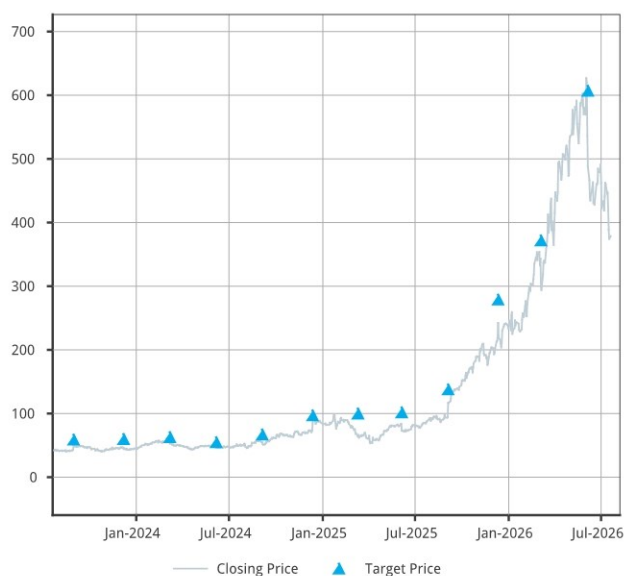
Ciena Corporation (CIEN / CIEN)

Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 408.73** (21-Jul-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart (as of 21-Jul-2026)



Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target	Currency
05-Jun-2026	535.63		607.00	USD
05-Mar-2026	299.30		372.00	USD
11-Dec-2025	221.85		279.00	USD
04-Sep-2025	94.82		138.00	USD
05-Jun-2025	83.89		102.00	USD
11-Mar-2025	63.95		100.00	USD
12-Dec-2024	73.21		97.00	USD
04-Sep-2024	55.35		67.00	USD
06-Jun-2024	48.56		55.00	USD
07-Mar-2024	61.96		63.00	USD
07-Dec-2023	45.76		60.00	USD
31-Aug-2023	43.16		59.00	USD

On 22-Jul-2023, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 66.00 USD.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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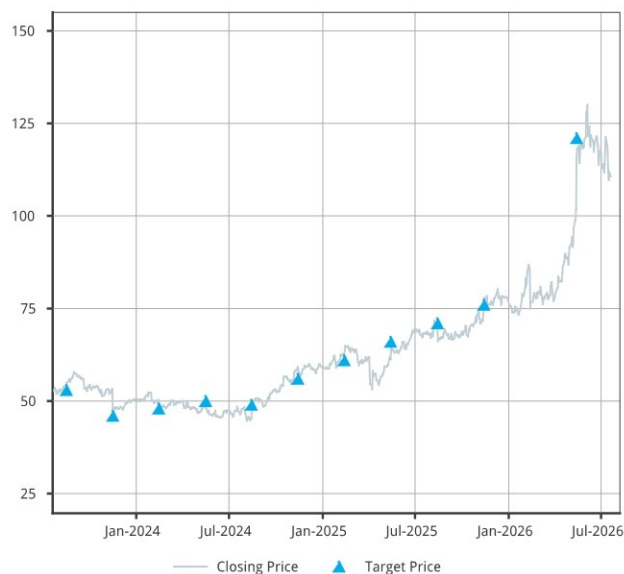
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Valuation Methodology: Our price target of \$607 reflects a P/E multiple of 50x our FY28 EPS estimate of \$12.14, a premium to the 2-year average that we believe is justified based on expected triple-double-digit EPS growth in FY26e and DD growth in FY27e-FY28e.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: 1) Competition. The optical space is very competitive given high growth relative to other networking segments. 2) Volatility. Ciena's business with Telcos has consistently been lumpy, and Cloud players could become more volatile. 3) Vertical integration. Cloud vendors like to vertically integrate, though efforts to do so in optical have stalled.

Cisco Systems, Inc. (CSCO / CSCO)Stock Rating: **EQUAL WEIGHT**Industry View: **NEUTRAL**Closing Price: **USD 112.18** (21-Jul-2026)**Rating and Price Target Chart (as of 21-Jul-2026)**

Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target	Currency
14-May-2026	101.87		121.00	USD
13-Nov-2025	73.96		76.00	USD
14-Aug-2025	70.40		71.00	USD
14-May-2025	61.29		66.00	USD
12-Feb-2025	62.43		61.00	USD
13-Nov-2024	59.18		56.00	USD
14-Aug-2024	45.44		49.00	USD
16-May-2024	49.67		50.00	USD
14-Feb-2024	50.28		48.00	USD
16-Nov-2023	53.28		46.00	USD
17-Aug-2023	52.96		53.00	USD

On 22-Jul-2023, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Equal Weight, and the adjusted price target was 51.00 USD.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our PT of \$121 is based on a 25x P/E multiple on our CY27e EPS estimate of \$4.85.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: 1) Cloud. Cisco's shares in key hardware segments are much higher on-prem then on the cloud, so the transition may negatively impact revenues. 2) Software transition. Management is investing to keep the move to software rolling. However, many in the industry are hesitant to take as-a-service offerings for typical hardware purchases. 3) Macro. Future macroeconomic softness could pressure the IT spending environment, and could continue to depress sales growth if economic and/or political uncertainty persist. Upside risks include future share gains in core verticals, better traction in software and cloud, and macro holding up better than expected.

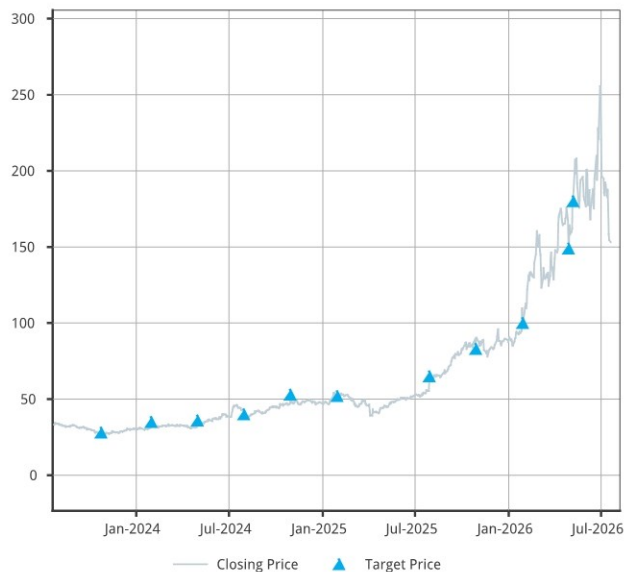
Corning Incorporated (GLW / GLW)

Stock Rating: **EQUAL WEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 162.41** (21-Jul-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart (as of 21-Jul-2026)



Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target	Currency
07-May-2026	181.57		180.00	USD
28-Apr-2026	168.01		149.00	USD
28-Jan-2026	109.74		100.00	USD
28-Oct-2025	89.37		83.00	USD
29-Jul-2025	55.41		65.00	USD
29-Jan-2025	51.23		52.00	USD
29-Oct-2024	46.84		53.00	USD
30-Jul-2024	42.68		40.00	USD
30-Apr-2024	31.78		36.00	USD
30-Jan-2024	31.15		35.00	USD
24-Oct-2023	26.86		28.00	USD

On 22-Jul-2023, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Equal Weight, and the adjusted price target was 33.00 USD.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our \$180 price target is based on the stock trading at 37x our FY28e EPS of \$4.85. We still see a number of long-term drivers for GLW, including diverse end market exposure and dominant technological and competitive positions in verticals benefiting from secular growth. However, we are concerned about a few of the key end markets, given uncertain macro.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: The key downside risk factors for Corning, in our view, include the following: (i) decreased demand for LCDs, particularly for TVs, or more rapid price erosion following LCD manufacturing consolidation (ii) a sustained slowdown in the Optical business due to reduced pace of data center investments, network upgrades, or fiber buildouts (e.g. FTTH); (iii) incremental growth from new businesses, particularly in Automotive and Life Sciences, failing to materialize. Upside risk factors include the following: (i) sustained consumer demand in Display, (ii) rapid margin expansion within the Optical segment, (iii), rapid content growth in smartphones, (iv) rapid automotive recovery and (v) new growth engines (e.g. gasoline particulate filters, Valor Glass) ramping up quicker than expected as the market environment recovers.

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